Informed Consent for Post-Survey

Dear Participant,

We are student researchers in the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology program at Southwestern University-PHINMA. We are conducting this capstone study:

Architecting a Lightweight Cloud-Based Inventory and Financial Management System: A Mixed-Methods Evaluation of Decision-Making Efficiency in Philippine SMEs

The study examines inventory and financial recordkeeping in Philippine small and medium enterprises and evaluates Kodigo, a cloud-based inventory and financial management system.

Purpose and what you will do

You are invited because you used or evaluated Kodigo during beta testing. If you agree, you will complete a 19-statement post-survey about cost-effectiveness, system reliability, operational efficiency, and security. It should take about 10 to 15 minutes. The questionnaire does not ask for your name, password, or account credentials. You may leave any item unanswered.

Possible risks and benefits

There is no direct benefit promised. Rating a system used by your business may feel sensitive. You may skip an item. Do not write passwords, customer information, or confidential transaction details on the questionnaire.

Voluntary participation and withdrawal

Taking part is voluntary. You may decline or stop before submitting your questionnaire without penalty or effect on your relationship with the university or your business. Because the questionnaire does not collect a name or unique code, the researchers may be unable to locate and remove your response after it has been submitted.

Privacy and use of information

The signed consent form will be stored separately from the questionnaire. The researchers will not include your personal name or login details in the thesis and will report the ratings in summary form. Because this study includes one client post-survey, people familiar with the project may infer who responded even if your name is omitted. Access to records will be limited to the research team and academic adviser; records will be retained and disposed of under university research requirements.

Researcher contacts

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Agreement

I have read or had this form explained to me and had a chance to ask questions. I understand that participation is voluntary, that I may skip items or stop before submitting, and that a submitted response cannot usually be withdrawn because it is not linked to my name. I freely agree to complete the post-survey.

Participant name (print, optional): _____

Participant signature: _____ Date: _____